

BC Housing Market Analysis Report

Greater Vancouver Area - Q2 2026

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1. Market Overview

The Greater Vancouver Area rental market continued its trajectory of constrained supply and elevated demand through Q2 2026. The benchmark rent for a one-bedroom apartment reached \$2,650 per month, representing a 4.5% year-over-year increase. The rental vacancy rate remained at a critically low 1.3%, well below the national average of 2.8%. Immigration, interprovincial migration, and returning post-secondary students continue to be the primary demand drivers.

2. Rental Price Data by Region

Region	Studio	1 Bedroom	2 Bedroom	3 Bedroom
Downtown Vancouver	\$2,100	\$3,200	\$4,500	\$6,800
West End / Coal Harbour	\$1,950	\$3,100	\$4,300	\$6,200
Yaletown / False Creek	\$2,200	\$3,400	\$4,750	\$7,000
Kitsilano / Point Grey	\$1,900	\$2,900	\$4,100	\$5,800
East Vancouver	\$1,700	\$2,400	\$3,200	\$4,500
Burnaby / Metrotown	\$1,750	\$2,500	\$3,300	\$4,600
North Vancouver	\$1,850	\$2,700	\$3,600	\$5,100
Richmond	\$1,650	\$2,350	\$3,100	\$4,300

3. Key Market Indicators

Average days on market fell to 6.2 days in Q2 2026, down from 8.1 days in Q1. Approximately 73% of new listings received multiple applications within 48 hours of posting. This intense competition has pushed effective rents above listed prices in several submarkets, with renters offering above-asking rents and prepaid deposits to secure units.

4. Supply Pipeline

New purpose-built rental completions in Q2 2026 totalled 1,240 units across the Greater Vancouver Area, significantly below the estimated demand of 4,500 units per quarter. Approximately 8,500 rental units are under construction with expected completion dates in 2027-2028. The slow pace of new supply entering the market is expected to keep vacancy rates below 2% through the end of 2026.

5. Forecast and Recommendations

Rents are forecast to increase an additional 2-3% in Q3 2026, driven by the annual influx of university and college students in September. The UBC and SFU fall semester is expected to bring approximately 12,000 new students seeking accommodation in the Lower Mainland.

Policy Recommendation: The provincial government should consider additional incentives for purpose-built rental construction to address the structural supply deficit. Fast-tracking rezoning applications for rental-only developments could bring additional supply to market within 18-24 months.

Report prepared for distribution to member organizations.

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